

L2A™

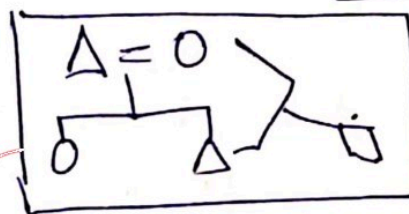
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Q2. (a) Incest avoidance functions as a mechanism to propel the individual into new relationships and social territory. Discuss

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• Incest refers to indulging in sexual relations with person of blood relations.

• Incest taboo is practised in many societies. For eg: Mother-son incest taboo



△ → male
○ → female
= → marriage
└┐ →

Theories of Incest Taboo

1) Psychoanalytic Theory - By Freud

• A ~~son~~ child (~~son~~) does not indulge in incest with her mother due to fear of father. When child grow up, he prevents his son to indulge in incest

This way the cycle continues.

- However this theory does not explain why many societies without father have incest taboo.

2) Family Disruption Theory - Malinowski

- Incest Taboo helps in maintaining stability and peace in family by avoiding role conflicts.

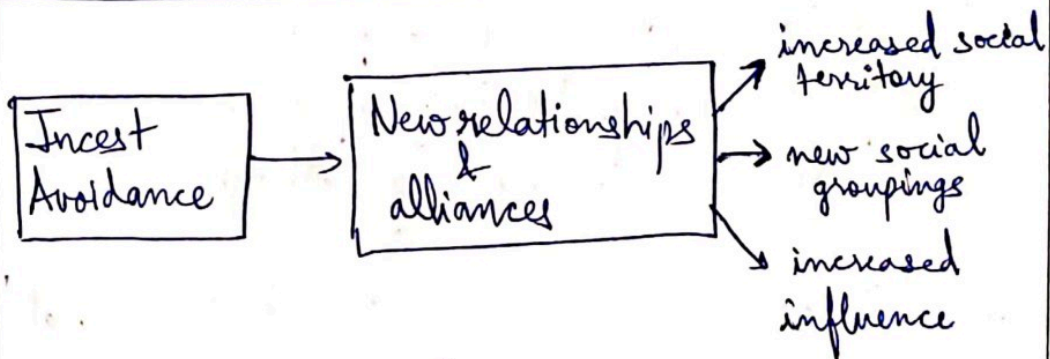
3) Family cooperation Theory - Levi Strauss

- Incest Taboo / avoidance helps various groups to avoid hostility of other group by entering into marriage alliances.

Incest Taboo mechanism to propel individual into new relationships. & social territory

- 1) It helps different exogamous groups to maintain alliances with other groups.

- 2) These alliances are helpful during times of contingency like war & food shortage.
- 3) New relationships are formed with other clans.
- 4) These new relationships help increase social territory of individual.



However, there are many societies where incest is still followed. For example:
~~exist~~ among tribes of Myanmar.

☆ According to Levi Strauss, new alliances through exchange of women helps clans to defend each other during wars.

☆ M. Fortes opines that alliances leads to political stability among different tribes.

Hence, it can be argued that incest avoidance facilitates ~~all~~ making of alliances which becomes beneficial for many tribes.